

— EDITION 03

The 7 Lauers of the AI Payments Stack

Everyone is building better fintech dashboards. Nobody is building the architecture for autonomous money. Here is the blueprint.

A 9-part breakdown

SWIPE >>>>

0101 / 09

The New Architectural Blueprint.

Agentic commerce requires a completely net-new financial infrastructure stack. It spans all the way from the LLM brain down to the physical settlement ledger.

0202 / 09

| Layer 7: The Application Layer (LLM).

The user-facing AI model or agent framework that parses human intent, evaluates options, and explicitly decides to make a purchase.

0303 / 09

Layer 6: The Protocol Layer.

Open web standards—such as emerging Universal Commerce Protocols—that enable autonomous software agents to query merchant catalogs cleanly.

0404 / 09

Layer 5: The Identity Layer.

Decentralized Identifiers (W3C DIDs) and cryptographic signatures proving that a software agent is genuinely authorized by a verified human or corporate entity.

0505 / 09

Layer 4: The Permissioning Layer.

Smart policy engines and guardrails (like session keys) that define strict boundaries on maximum budgets, approved vendor lists, and expiration dates.

0606 / 09

Layer 3: The Wallet & Vault Layer.

Secure tokenization environments where raw financial credentials or balances live, completely isolated from the main LLM to prevent prompt injection leaks.

0707 / 09

Layer 2: The PSP Orchestration Layer.

Dynamic payment service routing that automatically calculates the most efficient, cost-effective processing gateway for a machine transaction.

0808 / 09

Layer 1: The Settlement Layer.

The final movement of value across the network. This pits real-time domestic rails (FedNow/RTP) directly against internet-native stablecoin ledgers.

0909 / 09

Which Layer Will Take the Highest Take-Rate?

Value always accrues where the friction is solved. The layers that successfully crack Permissioning and Secure Vault Isolation will capture the highest enterprise margins.

— THE TAKEAWAY

Found this **useful?**

Repost to share it with your network, and follow for weekly breakdowns of the agentic payments stack.

◆ Joseph Bankole